POLITICAL PARTIES

PARTY AS DEMOCRATIC INTERMEDIARY → SECTION 29A REGISTRATION AND → RECOGNITION AND SYMBOL ARCHITECTURE → PARTY SYSTEM EVOLUTION, REGIONALISATION → INTERNAL DEMOCRACY, MEMBERSHIP, CANDIDATES → FINANCE AND THE ELECTORAL-BONDS

Read the thick cape rail from Stage 00 to the final cape synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g5 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

PARTY AS DEMOCRATIC INTERMEDIARY, NOT CONSTITUTIONAL SOVEREIGN

PARTY AS DEMOCRATIC INTERMEDIARY, NOT CONSTITUTIONAL SOVEREIGN · ROOT QUESTION · HOW CAN PARTIES AGGREGATE CITIZENS AND GOVERN WITHOUT BECOMING · DEMOCRATIC FUNCTIONS REPRESENTATION · PROGRAMME CHOICE GOVERNMENT · LEGISLATIVE COORDINATION · LEGAL LOCATION ORIGINAL CONSTITUTION · NO COMPREHENSIVE PARTY CODE.

ROOT QUESTION

How can parties aggregate citizens and govern without becoming private constitutional sovereigns? → DEMOCRATIC FUNCTIONS representation → programme choice government

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ROOT QUESTION
- How can parties aggregate citizens and govern without becoming private constitutional sovereigns?
- DEMOCRATIC FUNCTIONS representation

POWER / PROCEDURE

- programme choice government
- legislative coordination
- LEGAL LOCATION original Constitution: no comprehensive party code.

CHECK / LIMIT

- Tenth Schedule: defection only.
- RPA 1951: registration, contribution and disclosure fields.
- Symbols Order 1968: recognition and symbol disputes.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- TENSION public democratic power <–> Article 19(1)(c) associational autonomy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TENSION public democratic power <–> Article 19(1)(c) associational autonomy.

01

STAGE 01

SECTION 29A REGISTRATION AND ECI'S BOUNDED CANCELLATION POWER

SECTION 29A REGISTRATION AND ECI'S BOUNDED CANCELLATION POWER · SECTION 29A ASSOCIATION APPLIES TO ECI · ALLEGIANCE DECLARATION TO CONSTITUTION, SOCIALISM, SECULARISM, DEMOCRACY, SOVEREIGNTY, UNITY · RECOGNITION REGISTRATION CREATES STATUTORY PARTY STATUS · RECOGNITION FOLLOWS SYMBOLS ORDER PERFORMANCE CRITERIA · INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS V. INSTITUTE OF SOCIAL WELFARE (2002) · ECI HAS NO GENERAL REVIEW/DEREGISTRATION POWER · NARROW CANCELLATION SURVIVES FOR FRAUD, FOUNDATIONAL DISQUALIFICATION OR ANALOGOUS

SECTION 29A association applies to ECI → memorandum/rules → allegiance → declaration to Constitution, socialism, secularism, democracy, sovereignty, unity and integrity. → REGISTRATION != RECOGNITION registration creates statutory party status → recognition follows Symbols Order performance criteria. → Indian National Congress v. Institute of Social Welfare (2002)

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- SECTION 29A association applies to ECI → memorandum/rules → allegiance
- declaration to Constitution, socialism, secularism, democracy, sovereignty, unity and integrity.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- REGISTRATION != RECOGNITION registration creates statutory party status
- recognition follows Symbols Order performance criteria.

CHECK / LIMIT

- Indian National Congress v. Institute of Social Welfare (2002)
- ECI has no general review/deregistration power

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- narrow cancellation survives for fraud, foundational disqualification or analogous grounds.
- TRAP loss of recognition, symbol consequence and deregistration are different legal events.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP loss of recognition, symbol consequence and deregistration are different legal events.

02

STAGE 02

RECOGNITION AND SYMBOL ARCHITECTURE WITHOUT FREEZING PARTY LISTS

RECOGNITION AND SYMBOL ARCHITECTURE WITHOUT FREEZING PARTY LISTS · SYMBOLS ORDER 1968 RECOGNISED NATIONAL PARTY · RECOGNISED STATE PARTY · REGISTERED-UNRECOGNISED PARTY. · ANY ONE DATED ROUTE · 6% VALID VOTES IN FOUR OR MORE STATES + · 2% LOK SABHA SEATS FROM AT LEAST THREE STATES · STATE-PARTY RECOGNITION IN FOUR STATES.

SYMBOLS ORDER 1968 recognised National party	recognised State party	registered-unrecognised party.	
STATE: ANY ONE DATED ROUTE vote-plus-seat tests	3% or three Assembly seats	Lok Sabha ratio route	8% vote route.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- SYMBOLS ORDER 1968 recognised National party
- recognised State party
- registered-unrecognised party.
- NATIONAL: ANY ONE DATED ROUTE

POWER / PROCEDURE

- 6% valid votes in four or more States + four Lok Sabha seats
- 2% Lok Sabha seats from at least three States
- State-party recognition in four States.
- STATE: ANY ONE DATED ROUTE vote-plus-seat tests

CHECK / LIMIT

- 3% or three Assembly seats
- Lok Sabha ratio route
- 8% vote route.
- PRIVILEGE reserved symbol and specified electoral facilities.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CONTROL criteria are Order-based and re-verifiable; do not freeze the current party list.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTROL criteria are Order-based and re-verifiable; do not freeze the current party list.

03

STAGE 03

PARTY SYSTEM EVOLUTION, REGIONALISATION AND COALITION FEDERALISM

PARTY SYSTEM EVOLUTION, REGIONALISATION AND COALITION FEDERALISM · 1952-1967 CONGRESS SYSTEM · 1967 FRAGMENTATION · 1977 ALTERNATION · 1989-2014 COALITION BARGAINING · 2014/2019 SINGLE-PARTY UNION MAJORITIES · COALITION-SUPPORTED UNION GOVERNMENT AFTER THE 2024 ELECTION · CONTINUED STRONG STATE-PARTY COMPETITION.

1952-1967 Congress system → 1967 fragmentation → 1977 alternation → 1989-2014 coalition bargaining → 2014/2019 single-party Union majorities → coalition-supported Union government after the 2024 election → continued strong State-party competition.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- 1952-1967 Congress system → 1967 fragmentation
- 1977 alternation → 1989-2014 coalition bargaining
- 2014/2019 single-party Union majorities

POWER / PROCEDURE

- coalition-supported Union government after the 2024 election
- continued strong State-party competition.
- PARTY-SYSTEM TYPES one-party dominance

CHECK / LIMIT

- two-party tendency
- multi-party competition
- coalition system.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- REGIONAL PARTIES identity representation + State autonomy + policy innovation
- <–> personalisation + fragmentation + bargaining cost.
- 2022 GS-II centralisation/autonomy preference follows organisational position and power incentives, not a permanent ideological law.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2022 GS-II centralisation/autonomy preference follows organisational position and power incentives, not a permanent ideological law.

04

STAGE 04

INTERNAL DEMOCRACY, MEMBERSHIP, CANDIDATES AND DYNASTIC CONTROL

INTERNAL DEMOCRACY, MEMBERSHIP, CANDIDATES AND DYNASTIC CONTROL · MEMBERSHIP PUBLISHED ELIGIBILITY · RELIABLE ROLL · NOTICE/HEARING FOR DISCIPLINE · LEADERSHIP PERIODIC ELECTION · REAL COMPETITION · TRANSPARENT COUNTING · STATE-UNIT VOICE.

MEMBERSHIP published eligibility → reliable roll → notice/hearing for discipline → appeal. → LEADERSHIP periodic election → real competition → transparent counting → State-unit voice. → CANDIDATES local consultation + published criteria + integrity + representativeness → <– dynasty + money + winnability + central nomination. → CURRENT GAP

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- MEMBERSHIP published eligibility → reliable roll → notice/hearing for discipline → appeal.
- LEADERSHIP periodic election → real competition → transparent counting → State-unit voice.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- CANDIDATES local consultation + published criteria + integrity + representativeness
- <–> dynasty + money + winnability + central nomination.

CHECK / LIMIT

- CURRENT GAP
- ECI receives organisational particulars but no comprehensive statutory internal-democracy code exists.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- REFORM LIMIT minimum process safeguards must not authorise State selection of ideology or leaders.
- MEMBERSHIP published eligibility → reliable roll → notice/hearing for discipline → appeal.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REFORM LIMIT minimum process safeguards must not authorise State selection of ideology or leaders.

05

STAGE 05

FINANCE AND THE ELECTORAL-BONDS CONSTITUTIONAL RESET

FINANCE AND THE ELECTORAL-BONDS CONSTITUTIONAL RESET · STATUTORY SPINE · RPA SECTION 29B · CONTRIBUTIONS SUBJECT TO FOREIGN-SOURCE PROHIBITION. · SECTION 29C · REPORT CONTRIBUTIONS EXCEEDING RS 20,000; TAX-RELIEF CONSEQUENCE. · FCRA 2010 · POLITICAL PARTIES CANNOT ACCEPT FOREIGN CONTRIBUTION.

STATUTORY SPINE → RPA Section 29B: contributions subject to foreign-source prohibition. → Section 29C: report contributions exceeding Rs 20,000; tax-relief consequence. → FCRA 2010: political parties cannot accept foreign contribution. → Association for Democratic Reforms v. Union of India (2024)

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- STATUTORY SPINE
- RPA Section 29B: contributions subject to foreign-source prohibition.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Section 29C: report contributions exceeding Rs 20,000; tax-relief consequence.
- FCRA 2010: political parties cannot accept foreign contribution.

CHECK / LIMIT

- Association for Democratic Reforms v. Union of India (2024)
- Electoral Bond Scheme and enabling anonymity/unlimited-corporate changes struck down

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- voter Article 19(1)(a) right to information protected; SBI-ECI disclosure ordered.
- The verdict removed one opacity mechanism; it did not enact a complete finance code.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The verdict removed one opacity mechanism; it did not enact a complete finance code.

06

STAGE 06

WHIPS, ANTI-DEFECTION AND PARTY-SYMBOL IDENTITY

WHIPS, ANTI-DEFECTION AND PARTY-SYMBOL IDENTITY · PARTY ORGANISATION MEMBERSHIP, LEADERSHIP AND CANDIDATE SELECTION. · LEGISLATURE PARTY MEMBERS OF THE HOUSE BELONGING TO THE · TENTH SCHEDULE VOLUNTARY GIVING UP · VOTE/ABSTENTION DIRECTION · PRESIDING-OFFICER DECISION. · SYMBOLS ORDER · ECI DECIDES RIVAL-FACTION SYMBOL/RECOGNITION QUESTIONS.

PARTY ORGANISATION membership, leadership and candidate selection.

LEGISLATURE PARTY members of the House belonging to the political party. → TENTH SCHEDULE voluntary giving up → vote/abstention direction

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PARTY ORGANISATION membership, leadership and candidate selection.
- LEGISLATURE PARTY members of the House belonging to the political party.
- TENTH SCHEDULE voluntary giving up

POWER / PROCEDURE

- vote/abstention direction
- presiding-officer decision.
- SYMBOLS ORDER

CHECK / LIMIT

- ECI decides rival-faction symbol/recognition questions.
- Sadiq Ali v. Election Commission of India (1972) majority in organisational and legislative wings informs symbol identity.
- TRAP symbol dispute, internal leadership, whip authorisation and defection are related but legally separate proceedings.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- vote/abstention direction

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP symbol dispute, internal leadership, whip authorisation and defection are related but legally separate proceedings.

07

STAGE 07

CRIMINALISATION, DISCLOSURE AND NOTA LIMITS

CRIMINALISATION, DISCLOSURE AND NOTA LIMITS · UNION OF INDIA V. ASSOCIATION FOR DEMOCRATIC REFORMS (2002) · PUBLIC INTEREST FOUNDATION (2018) NO JUDICIALLY INVENTED PRE-CONVICTION BAN · RAMBABU SINGH THAKUR V. SUNIL ARORA (2020) PARTIES PUBLISH · LILY THOMAS V. UNION OF INDIA (2013) · SECTION 8(4) SHIELD INVALID; DISQUALIFICATION FOLLOWS CONVICTION. · A STAY OF CONVICTION DIFFERS FROM SUSPENSION OF SENTENCE. · LIMIT DUE PROCESS AND SPEEDY TRIALS MUST ACCOMPANY DISCLOSURE.

Union of India v. Association for Democratic Reforms (2002) + PUCL (2003) candidate criminal, financial and educational disclosure protects → Public Interest Foundation (2018) no judicially invented pre-conviction ban; wider publicity ordered. → Rambabu Singh Thakur v. Sunil Arora (2020) parties publish pending cases and qualification-based selection reasons.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Union of India v.
- Association for Democratic Reforms (2002) + PUCL (2003) candidate criminal, financial and educational disclosure protects informed voting.
- Public Interest Foundation (2018) no judicially invented pre-conviction ban; wider publicity ordered.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Rambabu Singh Thakur v. Sunil Arora (2020) parties publish pending cases and qualification-based selection reasons.
- Lily Thomas v. Union of India (2013)
- Section 8(4) shield invalid; disqualification follows convictions.

CHECK / LIMIT

- A stay of conviction differs from suspension of sentence.
- LIMIT due process and speedy trials must accompany disclosure.
- People's Union for Civil Liberties (2013)

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- NOTA protects negative secret choice but does not trigger automatic re-poll.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rambabu Singh Thakur v. Sunil Arora (2020) parties publish pending cases and qualification-based selection reasons.

08

STAGE 08

DONATIONS, DISCLOSURE AND FOREIGN-SOURCE CONTROLS

DONATIONS, DISCLOSURE AND FOREIGN-SOURCE CONTROLS · SECTION 29B PERMISSION · COMPANY/TAX CONTROLS · FCRA FOREIGN-SOURCE PROHIBITION. · SECTION 29C · CONTRIBUTIONS EXCEEDING RS 20,000 · TREASURER REPORT TO ECI BEFORE INCOME-TAX RETURN DUE DATE · NON-COMPLIANCE AFFECTS TAX RELIEF.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
Section 29B permission → company/tax controls → FCRA foreign-source prohibition.	non-compliance affects tax relief	audited party account	limit != Section 29C threshold lawful privacy != blanket donor anonymity.
Section 29C: contributions exceeding Rs 20,000	TRACEABLE ROUTES banking channel	beneficial ownership.	
treasurer report to ECI before income-tax return due date	electoral trust	DO NOT CONFLATE party contribution reporting != candidate expenditure tax cash	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Section 29B permission → company/tax controls → FCRA foreign-source prohibition.
- Section 29C: contributions exceeding Rs 20,000
- treasurer report to ECI before income-tax return due date

POWER / PROCEDURE

- non-compliance affects tax relief
- TRACEABLE ROUTES banking channel
- electoral trust

CHECK / LIMIT

- audited party account
- beneficial ownership.
- DO NOT CONFLATE party contribution reporting != candidate expenditure tax cash

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- limit != Section 29C threshold lawful privacy != blanket donor anonymity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DO NOT CONFLATE party contribution reporting != candidate expenditure tax cash limit != Section 29C threshold lawful privacy != blanket donor anonymity.

09

STAGE 09

JUDGMENT CHAIN AND BOUNDED INSTITUTIONAL POWERS

JUDGMENT CHAIN AND BOUNDED INSTITUTIONAL POWERS · SADIQ ALI V. ELECTION COMMISSION OF INDIA (1972) · SYMBOL IDENTITY USES ORGANISATIONAL AND LEGISLATIVE SUPPORT. · UNION OF INDIA V. ASSOCIATION FOR DEMOCRATIC REFORMS (2002) · CANDIDATE INFORMATION AND INFORMED VOTING. · PUCL (2003) · DISCLOSURE SAFEGUARDS SUSTAINED. · INSTITUTE OF SOCIAL WELFARE (2002)

Sadiq Ali v. Election Commission of India (1972) → symbol identity uses organisational and legislative → Union of India v. Association for Democratic Reforms (2002) → candidate information and informed voting. → PUCL (2003) → disclosure safeguards sustained. → Institute of Social Welfare (2002) → no general ECI deregistration power.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Sadiq Ali v. Election Commission of India (1972) → symbol identity uses organisational and legislative support.
- Union of India v. Association for Democratic Reforms (2002)
- candidate information and informed voting.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- PUCL (2003) → disclosure safeguards sustained.
- Institute of Social Welfare (2002) → no general ECI deregistration power.
- Lily Thomas v. Union of India (2013) → Section 8(4) protection invalid.

CHECK / LIMIT

- Public Interest Foundation (2018) → no court-created pre-conviction ban.
- Rambabu Singh Thakur v. Sunil Arora (2020) → party publicity and selection reasons.
- Association for Democratic Reforms v. Union of India (2024)

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- electoral-bond anonymity struck down.
- State the exact proposition; do not turn a direction or narrow exception into a general power.
- People's Union for Civil Liberties (2013) → NOTA as negative secret choice.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: People's Union for Civil Liberties (2013) → NOTA as negative secret choice.

10

STAGE 10

PYQ DEMAND DECODING AND EXECUTABLE ANSWER SPINE

PYQ DEMAND DECODING AND EXECUTABLE ANSWER SPINE · 2022 GS-II Q13 TEST CENTRALISATION/AUTONOMY PROPOSITION · INCENTIVES AND ORGANISATION · COALITION CHRONOLOGY · INSTITUTIONAL FEDERAL SAFEGUARDS · OTHER HIGH-YIELD DEMANDS INTERNAL DEMOCRACY · REGULATION AT EDGES/INTERIOR · FINANCE AFTER 2024 CRIMINALISATION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
2022 GS-II Q13 test centralisation/autonomy proposition → incentives and organisation	regulation at edges/interior	fragmented oversight.	QUALITY CONTROL exact year/paper/marks/words
coalition chronology → counter-evidence → institutional federal safeguards → verdict.	finance after 2024 criminalisation	ANSWER METHOD opening thesis → correct legal source → mechanism → named evidence	no-party-list padding
OTHER HIGH-YIELD DEMANDS internal democracy	coalition federalism	limitation/counter → proportionate reform → one-line verdict.	answer-specific compression.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- 2022 GS-II Q13 test centralisation/autonomy proposition → incentives and organisation
- coalition chronology → counter-evidence → institutional federal safeguards → verdict.
- OTHER HIGH-YIELD DEMANDS internal democracy

POWER / PROCEDURE

- regulation at edges/interior
- finance after 2024 criminalisation
- coalition federalism

CHECK / LIMIT

- fragmented oversight.
- ANSWER METHOD opening thesis → correct legal source → mechanism → named evidence
- limitation/counter → proportionate reform → one-line verdict.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- QUALITY CONTROL exact year/paper/marks/words
- no-party-list padding
- answer-specific compression.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: coalition chronology → counter-evidence → institutional federal safeguards → verdict.

11

STAGE 11

UPSC ANSWER SYNTHESIS AND REFORM BALANCE

UPSC ANSWER SYNTHESIS AND REFORM BALANCE · PRELIMS FIREWALL · 29A REGISTRATION · FREE SYMBOL RECOGNITION LOSS · LEGISLATURE PARTY · BONDS VERDICT · FINANCE CODE · MAINS SPINE DEMOCRATIC ROLE

PRELIMS FIREWALL → 29A registration != recognition → reserved != free symbol recognition loss != deregistration → disclosure != disqualification → NOTA != re-poll

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PRELIMS FIREWALL
- 29A registration != recognition
- reserved != free symbol recognition loss != deregistration
- disclosure != disqualification

POWER / PROCEDURE

- NOTA != re-poll
- party != legislature party
- bonds verdict != finance code.
- MAINS SPINE democratic role -> segmented legal basis -> party-system evolution

CHECK / LIMIT

- internal democracy -> finance -> criminalisation -> whip/symbol interfaces
- autonomy-transparency balance -> reform.
- REFORM PACKAGE verified internal elections
- candidate criteria

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- donation transparency independent audit
- trial expedition
- narrow deregistration amendment proportionate ECI power + judicial review.
- VERDICT regulate the party's public consequences while preserving its legitimate associational core.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT regulate the party's public consequences while preserving its legitimate associational core.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · PART A — FEATURES OF THE INDIAN PARTY SYSTEM · PART B — RECOGNITION · NATIONAL VS STATE PARTIES · MULTI-PARTY SYSTEM — NATIONAL, STATE AND REGISTERED-UNRECOGNISED PARTIES OPERATE · AVOID UNVERIFIABLE GLOBAL SUPERLATIVES. · ONE-DOMINANT-PARTY SYSTEM — RAJNI KOTHARI'S "CONGRESS SYSTEM" (DECLINED POST-1967). · LACK OF CLEAR IDEOLOGY (EXCEPT BJP, CPI, CPM); PERSONALITY

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- PART A — FEATURES OF THE INDIAN PARTY SYSTEM
- PART B — RECOGNITION: NATIONAL vs STATE PARTIES
- Multi-party system — national, State and registered-unrecognised parties operate at multiple territorial scales
- avoid unverifiable global superlatives.

ADVANCED LIMIT

- One-dominant-party system — Rajni Kothari's "Congress system" (declined post-1967).
- Lack of clear ideology (except BJP, CPI, CPM); personality cult ; parties based on religion/caste/language .
- Emergence of regional parties ; factions & defections ; lack of an effective Opposition .
- Reserved symbol ; one proposer for nomination; broadcast time on state media; access to electoral rolls.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Star campaigners: recognised = 40 , registered unrecognised = 20 (their travel not counted in candidate expenditure).
- NOT: Parties are registered under the Constitution -> registered under Sec 29A, RPA 1951 (a statute).
- NOT: National-party status needs 6% votes in all states <– 6% in any 4+ states + 4 LS seats (or the alternatives).
- NOT: Recognised & unrecognised parties get the same star campaigners -> 40 vs 20 .

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels